

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

November 16, 2025

Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen teams up with Meal Ticket to modernise foodservice B2B payments

Meal Ticket, a software platform used by foodservice distributors, is plugging Adyen's rails directly into its workflow. Translation: distributors who still live on checks and phone-in cards can now accept digital payments, send pay-by-link, and reconcile invoices without the 1990s paperwork. Adyen's platform stack handles onboarding, KYC, risk and payouts under the hood, while its acquiring and fraud tools aim to lift approval rates and lower costs. What's the big deal? Foodservice distribution is a B2B niche with chunky invoices, complex AR, and tight margins. Embedding payments into the system-of-record can shrink days sales outstanding, reduce write-offs, and give invoice-level visibility that helps pricing and credit decisions. Add in richer transaction data that can qualify for better B2B interchange rates, and the economics start to improve. For Meal Ticket, payments become a sticky revenue stream and a moat. For Adyen, it's another push beyond retail into high-volume, under-digitised verticals—right where Stripe and others are circling too. The broader takeaway for payment execs: the next wave of growth is in niche B2B platforms, where embedded payments solve painful back-office problems and quietly rewire cash flow.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/press-release/20240826-meal-ticket-partners-with-adyen-to-launch-payment-solutions-for-food-servic-1/>

Article 2

Share the article details to craft your Adyen Finshots summary

I'm missing the specifics of the July 12, 2022 Adyen announcement. To deliver a sharp Finshots-style brief for payment industry execs, please share the key facts: What exactly did Adyen launch or change? Which markets, merchants, or platforms are impacted? Any numbers (coverage, pricing, authorization uplift, speed)? And what's the strategic angle—unified commerce, local acquiring, issuing/cards, embedded finance (accounts, capital), payouts, risk/3DS, tokenization, or Tap to Pay on iPhone? With those, I'll translate the "what happened" into "what it means": implications for PSP selection and vendor consolidation, checkout conversion and auth rates, cross-border costs, omnichannel rollout, orchestration strategy, and platform monetization. Paste the press release or bullet the highlights, and I'll return a concise headline (<100 chars) and a 150–200 word witty summary in simple language—focused on practical takeaways like whether this could lower processing costs, simplify integrations, improve data, or shift bargaining power. In short: give me the details, and I'll give you a Finshots-style summary you can use in the boardroom.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 3

Adyen taps Plaid to push pay by bank, taking aim at card fees

Adyen is teaming up with Plaid to make bank-to-bank payments and account verification a first-class citizen at checkout. Translation: merchants can let customers pay straight from their bank accounts with Plaid's slick account linking and risk checks, while Adyen handles processing, risk, and settlement. The pitch is simple—fewer card fees, fewer failed ACHs, and better conversion than clunky microdeposits. It's tailor-made for bill pay, subscriptions, and high-ticket purchases where every basis point counts. For Adyen, this deepens its account-to-account stack and keeps it competitive with peers already leaning on Plaid. For Plaid, it's more payments volume and distribution into Adyen's global merchant base. The catch? Pay-by-bank still lacks card-like perks (rewards, chargeback protections) and can be slower to settle, so it won't topple cards overnight. But if the user experience keeps improving, expect incremental share shifts from cards—especially in cost-sensitive categories. Bottom line: this alliance nudges open banking from buzzword to business case, and puts a little more pricing pressure on the card rails.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 4

Quick check: Please share the full Adyen article to craft the Finshots brief

Your note hints at a BNPL surge this holiday season and mentions a “Swedish financial giant” (likely Klarna), but the core details about Adyen are missing. To deliver a crisp, Finshots-style summary for payment execs, I need a few specifics: 1) What exactly happened with Adyen — a partnership, product launch, pricing change, mandate win, or earnings update? 2) Who's the counterparty (Klarna/ Affirm/another player) and which markets are covered (US, EU, global)? 3) Any numbers that matter — TPV, merchant reach, take rates, conversion lift, stock reaction, or guidance updates? 4) The strategic angle — does this shift BNPL flows onto Adyen rails, displace a rival acquirer, improve merchant economics, or change funding/credit risk exposure? 5) Timing and the tie-in to holiday volumes and 2025 outlook. Share a link or bullet points and I'll turn it into a 150–200 word explainer on what it means for processors, scheme routing, margins, and checkout conversion — no jargon, just the signal execs need.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 5

Square adds bitcoin payments for small businesses

Small businesses are feeling the heat to keep up with shiny new tech, and Square just handed them a crypto lifeline. The payments company is rolling out bitcoin payment capabilities, letting merchants accept BTC alongside cards and wallets. The pitch is simple: attract crypto-savvy customers, burnish your “innovator” badge, and maybe open up new cross-border sales without the card toll booth. For Square, it’s a way to deepen merchant stickiness in a crowded POS market and lean into the broader Block playbook around digital assets. What’s the catch? Demand is still niche, bitcoin’s price swings can spook finance teams, and compliance and tax reporting aren’t exactly fun. If Square offers easy conversion to fiat and clear reconciliation tools, that could blunt the volatility and back-office pain. Expect early traction in ecommerce, tourism, and high-margin categories where customers are more likely to experiment. For payment execs, the signal is bigger than the feature: crypto acceptance is moving from fringe add-on to mainstream checkbox. The winners will be those who make it effortless, auditable, and cheaper than the status quo—without scaring risk teams.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Article 6

Square’s new “Handheld” ditches the phone for mobile POS

Square built its brand on tiny dongles that turned your phone into a card machine. Now it’s cutting the phone out altogether. The company’s new device, “Handheld,” is a dedicated, mobile point-of-sale that puts the screen, software, and card reader into one unit so staff can take payments anywhere—no pairing, no battery anxiety, fewer moving parts. Why this matters: phone-based POS has been getting crowded (hello, Apple’s Tap to Pay), and retailers and restaurants want something rugged, reliable, and consistent across teams. By owning the hardware end-to-end, Square can promise tighter integration with its software stack—inventory, customer profiles, analytics—and create stickier merchant relationships. It also nudges Square further into the mid-market, where handhelds help bust queues and speed table-side payments, directly competing with Toast, Clover, and Shopify’s POS Go. For merchants, it’s a simpler setup and potentially lower support headaches. For Square (and Block), more endpoints in the wild typically mean more payment volume flowing through its rails. Translation: the dongle era isn’t dead, but Square is hedging with a phone-free future to keep checkout firmly in its own hands.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Square brews its first in-store bitcoin sale at Compass Coffee

Coffee for crypto, anyone? In Washington, D.C., Compass Coffee just became the first merchant to ring up a bitcoin sale using Square's new point of sale. Why it matters: Square is pushing bitcoin acceptance from app-based experiments into the countertop checkout. If this scales, merchants could accept bitcoin alongside cards on the same hardware and software, which lowers adoption friction. The economics could shift too: no card interchange, but there are network fees and price volatility to contend with. Merchant appeal will hinge on whether Square offers instant conversion to dollars, who pays the network fee, how refunds work, and what the tax/accounting treatment looks like. Adoption reality check: crypto payments remain niche, so don't expect volumes to flip overnight. Still, putting it inside mainstream POS gives merchants optionality and a marketing hook for tech-savvy customers and tourists. Strategically, it extends the company's long-running bitcoin bet and could boost stickiness by making Square the hub for whatever tender a shopper brings. What to watch: rollout beyond pilots, pricing versus card rates, and whether big chains test it.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

